

Tweak your network adapter properties

The network adapter settings have several options that can be tinkered around. We show you how you can make the most of it.

IT'S QUITE POSSIBLE that you must have fiddled around with your network adapter properties menu in Windows. Changing your IP addresses and DNS gateways to disabling and enabling the adapter at times of need, you must have done something or the other. Apart from this basic tinkering, there are

by either virtual machines or VPN software. You need to remember that when you're making changes, it has to be done to the adapter with the active internet connection. So, if you're connected to the Internet wirelessly then you should make all the changes to the Wi-Fi adapter. Another way to reach the network

can find the Network Reset under Status in Network & Internet settings. Now that we're clear, let's begin.



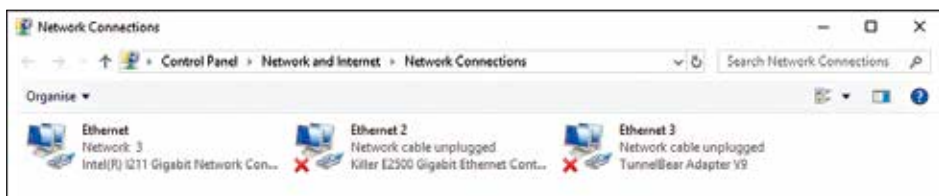
DISABLE FILE AND PRINTER SHARING FOR MICROSOFT NETWORKS

If you're using a single PC setup at home and you aren't going to connect any other Windows machine to the network, then you don't need the first two options under Networking in Ethernet Prop-



ENTER A THIRD-PARTY DNS SERVER ADDRESS MANUALLY

Although you might not have control over your external IP address by default, you can certainly play around with your DNS server address. Some big ISPs might have their own DNS servers but most of the new ones rely on Google's DNS server. What you need to know is that there many more DNS servers options out there that have their own benefits. Some are more secure while some are super fast. Changing the DNS servers can allow you to access some websites that have been blocked by the service provider. Since your DNS server is responsible for resolving website URLs, its speed can be a the defining point. We would recommend using Cloudflare's DNS servers which are 1.1.1.1 and 1.0.0.1. Otherwise, you can use Google's DNS servers – 8.8.8.8 and 8.8.4.4. To add these DNS



All your network adapters will be listed here

many more options available that allow you to do more. If you weren't of the curious kind and never played with the network adapter, you're in for a treat. The network adapter lets you control several options and settings for your wired and wireless connections. We will be going through some of the most essential tips.

Before heading over to the tips, if you're unaware where the menu is present, go to Settings in Windows 10 and open Network & Internet. Click on Ethernet on the left column and then go to "Change adapter options" on the right panel. All your Ethernet and Wi-Fi network adapters will be listed here including virtual ones created

adapter page is to right-click on the Network icon on the system tray and click on Open Network & Internet Settings. This will skip the step of having to go to Settings first. If you use the Start search menu a lot, then enter 'Ethernet Settings' in the search bar and the Ethernet window under Network & Internet will open. For keyboard warriors, press Win + X to throw up the secondary start menu and then press W. It takes you to the Network & Internet window. This is the quickest way to access your network adapters.

Through this article, if you happen to mess things up somewhere and your internet stops working, you can simply reset your network. You

erties. 'Clients for Microsoft Networks' and 'File and Printer Sharing for Microsoft Networks' can both be disabled to not only improve the security of your system but also the speed. This feature is used to establish a connection between two or more Windows operating systems. You should avoid disabling this feature in a multi PC environment, such as a workplace or college, since all of them are connected on a network to each other. However, at home, there's no need to keep them enabled.



Manually add DNS server addresses